



Flip flop

Sea lions, fur seals, and walruses use their front flippers to sit up straight. Their back flippers can turn forward. This means that they can walk, and even run, on dry land. True seals can only slide around on their bellies when they leave the sea.

Its smooth, streamlined body helps the seal speed away from killer whales and polar bears.



Blubber is between three to four inches (seven and 10 centimeters) thick.

Seal-eating seals

Leopard seals are fierce. They leap out of the sea and thump onto the ice to grab penguins and other seals.

*This seal is less than 6.5 feet (two meters) long from nose to back flippers.
An elephant seal can measure more than three times that!*

Hair seals, like this harbor or common seal, speed through the sea by moving their back flippers up and down.

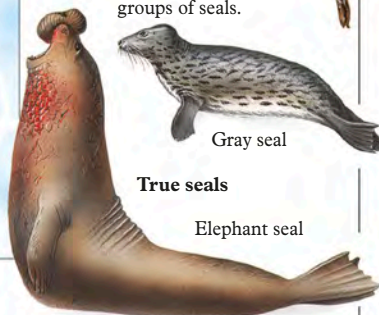
Types of seals

There are three different groups of seals.



Gray seal

True seals



Elephant seal

Eared seals

Northern fur seal



California sea lion



Walrus

Male walruses fight each other with their big tusks.

